



Android now the fastest growing mobile OS

Apple thrives on controversies, as we all know. When iPhone 4 was released this summer, in spite of some criticism from the tech press, it ended up flying off the shelves. Yet, even that success wasn't enough to prevent some of Apple's market share from going to Android. According to comScore, Android gained a 5 per cent market share in the period from April to July 2010. But all's not merry for the others: RIM lost 1.8 per cent and Microsoft lost 2.2 per cent.

According to the report, RIM and Apple are still at the top in the United States with 40 per cent and 24 per cent market share, respectively. Android is third on the list but has gained momentum from 12 per cent in April to 17 per cent in July, this year.

Such reports have been doing the rounds for some time now. A report from Quantcast in early September measured Web usage from smartphones and found that Android's market share increased by 17 per cent year on year. On the other hand, Apple and RIM lost 11 and 10 per cent, respectively. A recent report from Gartner has stated that Android is set to be the No. 2 OS, in terms of global market share, by the end of 2010. The report also stated that by 2014, Android would be battling for market share supremacy with Symbian from Nokia. In August, the NPD Group (a North American consumer research organisation) reported that Android accounted for 33 per cent of smartphone sales in the US, becoming the top selling smartphone platform in the country.

So, what is helping Android eat into the big players' market share? First, the OS is available on most mid-range to top-end smartphones and even on tablets. Apple, on the other hand, is losing out because of a lack of contract with some of the world's largest mobile carriers, such as Vodafone and Verizon. Finally, Microsoft was living in its own world before the release of Windows Phone 7, and RIM has been on a gradual losing streak for quite a while now. So, it's party time for Android.

More at: <http://bit.ly/AndroidOS>

Diaspora releases source code

Some say Diaspora, an open source social networking project that's in development, is hyped. Some say it will never see the light of day. But the four nerds have finally released the source code of Diaspora for the community to take

it through and make it win against an army that is 500 million strong and growing by the hour. A post on Diaspora's blog reveals its interface for the first time. It is likely that the project is not yet ready but as promised, the team is giving the world a glimpse of its open source alternative to Facebook and is also releasing the source code.

The initial appearance of



LG India launches first mobile from Optimus series

LG Electronics has just launched in India the first of its upcoming series of LG Optimus smartphones – the LG GT 540, an Android-powered smartphone that can be upgraded to version 2.1.

The phone is said to offer an optimal environment for first-time smartphone users with easy and convenient mobile access.

LG GT 540 claims to deliver



smartphone benefits in a Google Internet package. With an automatically synchronised Google account, users need to only log in once to enjoy YouTube, Gmail, Gtalk, Google Maps and more. With easy access to more than 30,000 downloadable applications and games from the Android market, users can easily customise and expand their LG Optimus experience.

Its advanced media player allows users to watch DivX and Xvid videos. The phone's 3MP camera supports geo-tagging, auto face-tagging and face-to-action technology, allowing you to create and share multimedia content from the phone.

LG GT 540 is now available at all retail outlets at ₹ 12,990.

More at: <http://bit.ly/LG-GT-540>